As provided by the Constitution, the Speaker of the last Lok Sabha vacates his/her office immediately before the first meeting of the newly-elected Lok Sabha. Therefore, the President appoints a member of the Lok Sabha as the Speaker *Pro Tem*. Usually, the seniormost member is selected for this. The President administers oath to the Speaker *Pro Tem*.

The Speaker *Pro Tem* has all the powers of the Speaker. He/she presides over the first sitting of the newly-elected Lok Sabha. His/her main duty is to administer oath to the new members. He/she also enables the House to elect the new Speaker.

When the new Speaker is elected by the House, the office of the Speaker *Pro Tem* ceases to exist. Hence, this office is a temporary office, existing for a few days[12].

 **Chairman of Rajya Sabha**

The presiding officer of the Rajya Sabha is known as the Chairman. The Vice-President of India is the *ex-officio* Chairman of the Rajya Sabha. During any period when the Vice-President acts as President or discharges the functions of the President, he/she does not perform the duties of the office of the Chairman of Rajya Sabha.

The Chairman of the Rajya Sabha can be removed from his/her office only if he/she is removed from the office of the Vice-President. As a presiding officer, the powers and functions of the Chairman in the Rajya Sabha are similar to those of the Speaker in the Lok Sabha. However, the Speaker has two special powers which are not enjoyed by the Chairman:

1. The Speaker decides whether a bill is a money bill or not and his/her decision on this question is final.

2. The Speaker presides over a joint sitting of two Houses of Parliament.

Unlike the Speaker (who is a member of the House), the Chairman is not a member of the House. But like the Speaker, the Chairman also cannot vote in the first instance. He/she too can cast a vote in the case of an equality of votes.

The Vice-President cannot preside over a sitting of the Rajya Sabha as its Chairman when a resolution for his/her removal is under consideration. However, he/she can be present and speak in the House and can take part in its proceedings, without voting, even at such a time (while the Speaker can vote in the first instance when a resolution for his/her removal is under consideration of the Lok Sabha).

As in case of the Speaker, the salaries and allowances of the Chairman are also fixed by the Parliament. They are charged on the Consolidated Fund of India and thus are not subject to the annual vote of Parliament.

During any period when the Vice-President acts as President or discharges the functions of the President, he/she is not entitled to any salary or allowance payable to the Chairman of the Rajya Sabha. But he/she is paid the salary and allowance of the President during such a time.

 **Deputy Chairman of Rajya Sabha**